The Founder's "What Do I Post?" Playbook

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Why you keep staring at a blank caption

Most founders who go quiet on content already have more material than they could ever post, and what's missing is a way to spot it and turn it into something people actually stop scrolling for.

I'm Pratikshit, and I run BrandsAscend. My team and I have edited and strategized content that has pulled in over 1 billion views and thousands of leads for the coaches and creators we work with. After sitting inside that many content calendars, the thing I see stall people most often is the moment right before filming, when they open their phone and have no idea what to say.

This playbook is the system I use with clients to fix that. It's built for founders who know their customers better than anyone and want content to bring in conversations without turning into a second full-time job.

What you'll walk away with: a way to mine 30 days of posts from your normal work week, the five post types that move a viewer toward a DM, a bank of hooks you can fill in tonight, and a 60-minute weekly routine that keeps you posting when things get busy.

Step 1: Mine your week instead of inventing ideas

Every post idea you need is already happening in your calendar, so the job is to catch it while it's fresh rather than brainstorm from zero on a Sunday night.

Keep one running note on your phone called **Content Mine**. Any time one of the moments below shows up, drop a single line in it. Five lines from each source gives you 30 posts.

Where it shows up	What to write down	The post it becomes
Customer questions	The exact words a customer or lead used when they asked	A direct answer, filmed as if you're replying to them
Sales calls	The objection that came up and how you handled it	"Here's what I tell people who think..."

Where it shows up	What to write down	The post it becomes
Decisions you made	A call you made this week and the reason behind it	A short story of the choice and what it taught you
Mistakes	Something that went wrong and what you changed after	An honest breakdown, which tends to build more trust than any win
The work itself	A process, a screen, a draft, a before-and-after	A behind-the-scenes walkthrough
Things you disagree with	Advice in your industry you think is wrong	Your take, backed by what you've seen firsthand

The quality bar is specificity. "Customers struggle with pricing" won't make a post, but "a guy on Tuesday told me he'd rather lose the deal than send a proposal over $2K" will, because the viewer can picture the moment and see themselves in it.

Step 2: Post the five types that climb the trust ladder

A stranger becomes a client by moving up a ladder of trust, and each post type below does one specific job on that ladder, so a feed that rotates through all five keeps pulling people toward your DMs.

1. **The Pattern Post (gets you noticed).** You name something you keep seeing across customers that they haven't put words to yet.
   - Example: "Every founder I talk to says they're bad on camera, and it's almost always because they're trying to sound like a guru instead of talking like they do on a sales call."
2. **The Teardown (proves you know your stuff).** You take one real situation apart and show what's working or broken in it.
   - Example: walk through a competitor's landing page or a common onboarding email and fix it live.
3. **The Story (makes people like you).** One moment from your week, told with the detail of what was said and what you felt.
   - Example: the call where a client almost walked and what changed their mind.

4. **The Proof Post (makes people believe you).** A client result told as a before-and-after, with the client's own words when you can get them.
    - Example: a screenshot of a message from a happy customer, plus the 30 seconds of context behind it.
5. **The Invitation (turns attention into conversations).** A direct, low-pressure ask that gives people a reason to reach out today.
    - Example: "I've got room for two founders this month. Comment PLAYBOOK and I'll send you how we'd map your first 30 days."

A simple weekly rhythm for five posts a week is one of each, in the order above. If you can only manage three, keep the Pattern Post and the Story, then rotate the last slot between the other three.

Step 3: Steal from this hook bank

The hooks that win are the ones where your ideal customer reads the first line and instantly knows the video is about their problem, because clever or abstract openers get scrolled past even when the content underneath is great.

One of the coaches I edit for rejects any on-screen text that makes a viewer think for more than a second, and the more clips I cut, the more I agree with him. Fill in the blanks below with words straight from your Content Mine.

Hook template	Best for
"The most common mistake I see [customer type] make with [problem]"	Pattern Post
"If you're [doing X] and still [frustrating result], watch this"	Pattern Post
"Everyone says [popular advice]. Here's what actually happens when you do it"	Pattern Post
"Let's fix this [landing page / offer / email] in 60 seconds"	Teardown
"Here's why [thing they're doing] is costing you [specific outcome]"	Teardown
"A client almost fired me last week"	Story

Hook template	Best for
"I made a [dollar amount] mistake so you don't have to"	Story
"What I'd do if I had to start [business type] from zero today"	Story
"[Client] went from [before] to [after] and it wasn't the thing you'd guess"	Proof Post
"This message from a client made my week"	Proof Post
"I'm opening [number] spots for [customer type] who want [outcome]"	Invitation
"Comment [WORD] and I'll send you [specific resource]"	Invitation

Write three versions of the hook for every post and pick the one a stranger would understand fastest. If you can, test two of them as on-screen text across separate uploads and keep whichever holds viewers past the first three seconds.

Step 4: Run the 60-minute weekly routine

One focused hour a week is enough to keep five posts going out, as long as you batch it and stop treating every post like its own project.

1. **Minutes 0 to 10: Review the mine.** Read your Content Mine note from the week and star the five lines that made you feel something when they happened.
2. **Minutes 10 to 20: Match and hook.** Assign each starred line to one of the five post types, then write three hooks for each using the bank above.
3. **Minutes 20 to 50: Film in one sitting.** Talk through each post the way you'd explain it to a customer on a call, one take each, no script beyond the hook and a single bullet of the point you're making.
4. **Minutes 50 to 60: Hand off or schedule.** Send the raw clips to your editor, or if you're doing it yourself, add captions and queue them for the week.

The founders who stay consistent are the ones who protect this hour like a client call, so put it in your calendar on the same day every week, ideally before Monday gets loud.

The mistakes that quietly kill founder content

These are the patterns I see most often when a founder tells me content "just doesn't work for them," and every one of them is fixable in a week.

- **Posting advice with no lived moment behind it.** Generic tips sound like every other account, while a specific story from your week is something only you can tell.
- **Waiting for the perfect setup.** A founder talking honestly into a phone beats a polished studio video with nothing real to say, and the gear can come later.
- **Writing hooks for yourself.** If the opening line needs your context to make sense, a stranger will scroll, so write it for someone who has never heard of you.
- **Only ever posting wins.** A feed of results with no struggle reads like an ad, and the mistake posts are usually the ones that make people trust you enough to reach out.
- **Never asking for anything.** Plenty of founders build an audience that likes them and then wonder why nobody books a call, which is why the Invitation post needs a regular slot.
- **Quitting at week three.** Most accounts look dead for the first few weeks because the algorithm is still figuring out who to show you to, so judge the system after 90 days of consistency.

Want this run for you?

Everything above works if you do it yourself, and if you'd rather spend that hour on your business, that's exactly what my done-for-you service **Ascend Your Brand** is built for.

We sit down with you once to map your Content Mine and your customer's biggest pains, then my team handles the strategy, hooks, scripting, editing and posting so you only show up to film. Clients like Dempz Carter have called us one of the most reliable teams they've worked with, and the same system has driven over 1 billion views for the creators we work with.

Next step: DM me the word **ASCEND** on Instagram at @iampratikshit or reach out through pratikshit.live, and I'll send you a quick breakdown of what your first 30 days of content could look like. I only take on a few founders at a time so every account gets my direct attention.